

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1085

By Lowe

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Johnny Ray Aikman of Meigs County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Johnny Ray Aikman of Meigs County; and

WHEREAS, Johnny Aikman was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Aikman was born on July 11, 1952, to Bill and Mary "Tookie" Aikman; and

WHEREAS, Johnny Aikman was the proud owner of Vac N' Stitch in Athens for forty years, where he built not only a successful business but also lifelong friendships with the many customers who came through his doors; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Aikman also faithfully served as chairman of the Election Commission in Meigs County for the past fourteen years, demonstrating his commitment to his community and to integrity in service to others; and

WHEREAS, a man of many passions, Johnny Aikman spent twenty years as a jet boat racer, chasing adventure and the thrill of the water; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Aikman loved being surrounded by people and took joy in sharing stories, smiles, and good company; he had a special way of making everyone feel welcome, whether through his easy laughter, heartfelt conversation, or genuine care for others; and

WHEREAS, Johnny Aikman's presence will be deeply missed, but his kindness, laughter, and love will continue to live on in the hearts of all who knew him; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Mr. Aikman always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Johnny Aikman is survived by his wife of thirty-six years, Helen Aikman; brothers, Ross Aikman and Jim Moore; nephews, Todd Aikman, Kevin (Tiffany) Aikman, and Elliott (Hannah) Aikman; nieces, Jada Aikman Leahy and Taylor Aikman; sister-in-law, Barbara Ray; special friends, Jeff Womac, Mike Franks, Ronnie Webb, John Webb, Jamie Webb, and Bill Kelley; and several cousins, great-nieces, and great-nephews; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Aikman was preceded in death by his brother, Robert "Herb" Aikman; and

WHEREAS, Johnny Aikman leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Johnny Ray Aikman, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Aikman.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

